



Discussion Guide: Mike McHargue

Wishing For the End: Responding to America's Suicide Crisis

Reflect

- As Mike opened his monologue, detailing the narrative of his own suicide attempt, he asked that everyone breathe. Take a moment and quietly reflect on how you felt as he told that story. Did you feel fear? Anger? Shame? Compassion? Something else? Once you identify how you felt, begin to explore why you might have felt that way.
- Mike describes the rising number of suicides in American as an “epidemic.” How does talking about suicide as an epidemic change the way you understand the problem and what it would take to address it effectively?
- Mike notes that some of the highest rates for suicide are found among white men who identify as being religiously and/or politically conservative. Does this surprise you? Why do you think this might be so?

Respond

- What has been your own experience with the topic of suicide? How have you heard it talked about in the church, on the news, and/or on social media?
- In your opinion, is suicide an issue that should be openly addressed by the church? If so, what could a faith community do to create space for talking about the reality of the suicide epidemic in America today?
- Mike locates the refusal to deal with the suicide crisis in the culture’s discomfort around the broader topic of death. How have you broached the topic of death, or even suicide, in your own families (with kids, aging parents, etc.)?